CASH TO COMPANY

Item Bank

"Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs"

Per-unit quiz / test items · 4 units · ETS-quality alignment to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS

Grade 3 — Cash to Company Item Bank

Year theme: *Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs.* This bank covers all four Grade 3 units (Skills, hobbies, needs · Five ideas from one problem · The lemonade math + the logo · Run the day, tell the truth, fix the flop). Items use short text + simple math (CCSS 3.OA.D.8). Distractors target the Common Misconceptions table for Grade 3. No family-money probes; "for a hypothetical" framing throughout. Cash's Grade 3 voice: "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

Unit 1: Skills, hobbies, needs

MC1. Cash asks: Where does a real business idea come from?

A. A skill, a hobby, OR a need you actually see · B. A wish · C. Whatever sounds rich · D. A dream you had

Answer: A · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3 — Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 3):** *I can complete a "Skills + Hobbies + Needs I See" web with at least 3 entries each, and circle two business ideas it suggests.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Ideas come from nowhere*" — C and D bait magical thinking.

MC2. Cash reads: "Maya is good at organizing (skill). She loves drawing (hobby). She notices kids in her class lose their pencils every day (need)." Which business idea fits all three?

A. A pencil-decorating service that includes a personalized organizer pouch · B. A car wash · C. A movie theater · D. A pencil factory

Answer: A · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.3.1 — Write opinion pieces.* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 3):** *I can complete a "Skills + Hobbies + Needs I See" web with at least 3 entries each, and circle two business ideas it suggests.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Any idea works for any kid*" — corrects by requiring fit.

MC3. Cash asks: "For a hypothetical 9-year-old, which is most important when picking ONE business idea from your web?"

A. The idea sounds fancy · B. The idea fits a real skill, a real hobby, AND a real need · C. The idea makes the most money · D. Your friend already had the idea

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4 — People can earn income by working for others or themselves (entrepreneurship).* · **Strand outcome (BAVC, 3):** *I can complete a "Skills + Hobbies + Needs I See" web.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*The fanciest idea wins*" — A and C bait this; B is the spine.

SA1. "Fill in your own Skills + Hobbies + Needs web. List 2 entries per column. Then circle one idea the web suggests."

Model answer: "*Skills: drawing, taking photos. Hobbies: making bracelets, watching dog videos. Needs: dogs need ID tags; classmates lose markers. Idea: hand-drawn photo dog ID tags.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Two entries per column AND a circled idea that combines at least two columns. - **2:** All columns filled but idea uses only one column. - **1:** Columns incomplete or no idea circled.

SA2. "Why is it riskier to pick a business idea that doesn't match your skills?"

Model answer: "*Because you have to learn the skill from scratch, and you may not know if you'll be good at it before customers expect a result.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Names "skill gap" AND customer-disappointment risk. - **2:** Names one of the two. - **1:** Cannot answer.

Performance Task: Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web (40 min, individual).

Child completes a 3-column web with at least 3 entries per column, circles two ideas the web suggests, and writes one sentence per circled idea explaining the fit. **Rubric:** Customer Research Rubric (Grade 3 scale-down): (1) all columns filled to 3+, (2) two ideas circled, (3) each idea defended with a fit-reason. **Strand outcome:** BAVC + PSIG.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*You picked an idea but you don't have one of the skills yet. Add a fourth column: 'Skills I Could Build.' What goes in it for your idea?*" Targets the Grade 3 advanced extension. Model: "*I'd need to learn how to use a label maker; I'd ask the librarian to teach me.*"

Unit 2: Five ideas from one problem

MC1. Cash reads: "Problem: kids' lunch trays drop in the cafeteria." Which is a good 'fifth idea' (most original)?

A. Buy stronger trays · B. Make trays with grippy bottoms · C. Hire a tray-carrier · D. A tray with a thumb-loop handle so it can't slip out of your hand

Answer: D · **Standard:** *NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1 — Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 3):** *I can generate at least 5 business ideas from a single problem prompt and pick the most "real-sounding" one with a reason.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*The first idea is always the best*" — corrects by rewarding original options.

MC2. "You generated 5 ideas. To pick the most 'real-sounding' one, which question matters most?"

A. Which is the cutest? · B. Which would my friend like? · C. Which would a real customer pay for? · D. Which is the cheapest to make?

Answer: C · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.3.1 — Write opinion pieces with reasons.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 3):** *I can generate at least 5 business ideas and pick the most "real-sounding" one with a reason.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*What I like is what customers want*" — corrects.

MC3. "You picked your idea. What's the next honest sentence to write?"

A. 'This is the best idea ever.' · B. 'This idea fits because [specific reason about customer need].' · C. 'This idea will make me rich.' · D. 'This idea is easy.'

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4.* · **Strand outcome (PSIG, 3):** *I can generate at least 5 business ideas and pick the most "real-sounding" one with a reason.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Bigger claims are better*" — A and C bait wealth-promise framing.

SA1. "Generate 5 ideas for the problem: 'kids forget their water bottles at school.' Pick the one most likely to be paid for, and tell me why in one sentence."

Model answer: "*1. Bottle clip-on tag with kid's name. 2. Bottle parking spot in each classroom. 3. Friday water drive. 4. Refillable bottle subscription. 5. Lost-bottle map. I'd pick the clip-on tag because parents would pay $1 to get the bottle back instead of buying a new one each month.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Five distinct ideas AND a reason that names the paying customer. - **2:** Five ideas, weak reason. - **1:** Fewer than 5, or no reason.

SA2. "You picked your idea. A classmate says, 'My idea is better.' How do you decide whose idea moves forward without fighting?"

Model answer: "*We list what each idea costs to make, who would buy it, and how much they'd pay. The idea with more answers wins for now.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Names evidence-based comparison (cost, buyer, price). - **2:** Names "ask people." - **1:** "Whoever is older wins" or no method.

Performance Task: 5-Idea Page + Pick (40 min, individual).

Child writes 5 ideas for one problem prompt, picks one, and writes a one-paragraph defense (3-5 sentences) using "this idea fits because" framing. **Rubric:** Reflection Writing Rubric (Grade 3): (1) 5 ideas distinct, (2) one circled with a reason, (3) defense names a customer or paying behavior. **Strand outcome:** PSIG + BAVC.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Of your 5 ideas, which would FAIL fastest? Why? (This is the 'premortem' question Cash asks at older grades.)*" Model: "*The Friday water drive — there's no way to get bottles back to the right kid; that's a delivery problem, not a water problem.*"

Unit 3: The lemonade math + the logo

MC1. "For a hypothetical lemonade stand: each cup costs you 30¢ to make. You sell each cup for 75¢. What is your profit per cup?"

A. 30¢ · B. 45¢ · C. 75¢ · D. $1.05

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 3.OA.D.8 — Solve two-step word problems using the four operations.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 3):** *I can calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a simple lemonade-stand scenario with whole-number prices.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Profit is whatever's in your hand at the end of the day*" — A is the cost; C is revenue; B is profit.

MC2. "For a hypothetical stand, you sell 20 cups at 75¢ each. Each cup costs 30¢. What is your TOTAL profit?"

A. $9 · B. $15 · C. $6 · D. $21

Answer: A · **Standard:** *CCSS-Math 3.OA.D.8.* · **Strand outcome (MFL, 3):** *I can calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a simple lemonade-stand scenario.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*More sales always means more profit no matter the cost*" — B baits revenue-as-profit; D adds them together.

MC3. (Two logos shown: Logo X is colorful and abstract; Logo Y plainly says "MAYA'S DOG-WALK · 555-1212.") Cash asks: Which logo helps the customer more?

A. Logo X — it's pretty · B. Logo Y — it tells the customer the name and how to reach Maya · C. Both equally · D. Logos don't matter

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CCSS-ELA W.3.1.* · **Strand outcome (CBM, 3):** *I can draw a logo and choose a name for my business idea and tell what each communicates to a customer.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*My logo has to be perfect*" — corrects with "clear beats fancy."

SA1. "For a hypothetical lemonade cup: cost 30¢ each, price 75¢ each, sold 25 cups. Show your math. What is the total profit?"

Model answer: "*Revenue: 25 × 75¢ = $18.75. Cost: 25 × 30¢ = $7.50. Profit: $18.75 - $7.50 = $11.25.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** All three numbers correct AND labeled. - **2:** Numbers correct but labeling missing or one minor arithmetic slip. - **1:** Multiple errors.

SA2. "For your business idea, choose a name and draw a logo idea in words (describe it). What does the name communicate? What does the logo communicate?"

Model answer: "*Name: Pencil Pals. The name says it's for kids' pencils, and 'Pals' shows it's friendly. Logo: a smiling pencil holding a pouch — communicates organization and fun.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Name AND logo each get a specific message-meaning paired with them. - **2:** Name OR logo decoded, not both. - **1:** Vague.

Performance Task: Cost / Revenue / Profit + Logo (60 min, individual).

Child completes a one-page worksheet with cost, revenue, and profit for a chosen business at three sales volumes (5, 10, 20 sales), then sketches a logo + name with one-sentence rationale for each. **Rubric:** Budget Project Rubric (Grade 3 scale-down): (1) all three CRP numbers correct at all three volumes, (2) name + logo present, (3) one-sentence rationale for each. **Strand outcome:** MFL + CBM.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*Your cost is 30¢/cup. What's the LOWEST price you could charge and still make any profit at all? What's wrong with picking that price?*" Model: 31¢ — but the profit is too small to be worth the work, so the price needs a cushion (anchors Grade 5's margin work).

Unit 4: Run the day, tell the truth, fix the flop

MC1. "For a hypothetical class market, you wrote a 5-step run-of-day list. The first step should be..."

A. Count the money · B. Sell to customers · C. Set up signs and supplies before customers come · D. Throw away leftovers

Answer: C · **Standard:** *NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-2 — Generate and compare multiple possible solutions.* · **Strand outcome (OSO, 3):** *I can list the 4–6 steps of running my business idea (open, sell, restock, close, count, clean) in order.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Order of steps doesn't matter*" — A and D bait wrong-end-of-day starts.

MC2. "Two real drinks: '100% juice' and 'juice drink (10% juice).' Which label is more honest about what's inside?"

A. Both equally honest · B. '100% juice' is honest because the label tells the truth about no other ingredients · C. 'Juice drink' is more honest because it sounds nicer · D. They are the same drink

Answer: B · **Standard:** *Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-2 — Use a basic decision-making process.* · **Strand outcome (ESL, 3):** *I can tell whether a business example is honest or misleading (e.g., "100% juice" vs. "juice drink") and give one reason.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*Honesty is just for grown-ups*" — corrects.

MC3. "Cash tells a story: a kid's first lemonade stand sold out fast but had no profit because each cup cost more than the price. What did the kid get wrong?"

A. They were unlucky · B. They didn't know their cost before setting their price · C. They sold too few · D. The recipe was bad

Answer: B · **Standard:** *CASEL Self-Awareness — Identify one's own skills and interests.* · **Strand outcome (LRCI, 3):** *I can describe one thing a "first try" business got wrong in a Cash story, and one fix the entrepreneur made.* · **Misconception targeted:** "*It's bad luck if I lose money*" — corrects with a concrete fixable cause.

SA1. "Write a 5-step run-of-day list for a hypothetical pencil-decorating stand."

Model answer: "*1. Set up sign and supplies. 2. Open at recess. 3. Sell pencils to customers, one at a time. 4. Restock supplies if low. 5. Close, count money, and clean.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** 4-6 steps in correct order, each verb-led and distinct. - **2:** Steps present but one out of order or duplicated. - **1:** Fewer than 4 steps or order broken.

SA2. "Cash's first-try story: the kid set the lemonade price too low. Tell me one fix the kid made the second day."

Model answer: "*The kid wrote down the cost per cup first (30¢), then set the price at double (60¢) to make sure profit was real.*"

Scoring guide (3-2-1): - **3:** Names a specific fix tied to cost-then-price logic. - **2:** Names "raised the price" without cost reasoning. - **1:** "Tried harder" or no specific fix.

Performance Task: Run-of-Day + Honesty + First-Try Fix (45 min).

Child runs a one-day class market using their run-of-day list, then writes a 1-paragraph reflection: (a) one thing my honesty was tested on, (b) one thing I'd fix tomorrow. **Rubric:** Reflection Writing Rubric (Grade 3): (1) run-of-day list followed, (2) honesty moment named specifically, (3) one fix written with reason. **Strand outcome:** OSO + ESL + LRCI.

Extension (advanced learner):

"*A customer accidentally gave you 5¢ too much. They've already left. What's the honest move?*" Model: track them down or hold the 5¢ until next time and tell them; the brand differentiator is honest claims build customers who come back.

Total this grade: 12 MC + 8 SA + 4 Performance Tasks + 4 Extensions = 28 items.